

MIRA

Stars: Trinary Yellow/White/White

Known for: The Floating Temples of the Icon City, Chelebs Dockyards, Miran Silk

Exports: Religious goods, textiles, grav projectors

Imports: Minerals, high tech, noble gases

Mira is a paradise where time has stood still since long before the Portal Wars. Every cycle, millions of pilgrims travel along the Miran chain to explore its many wonders. At first glance this system may seem to live in harmony with the Icons and their many teachings, but beneath the surface it boils with intrigue, violence, and discord.

CRADLE OF CIVILIZATION

The city-states of Mira are the cradle of Firstcome colonization and are considered by many to be its pinnacle – a loose federation of states that have enjoyed centuries of peaceful competition. Today, power is shared between the Church of the Icons, the Cities and the Chelebs-Menau family. The Church controls the Icon City from high up in the flying Temple City. The other large cities on the planet, like Bandar Asul, Tifret, and Cimoran, are ruled by local courts, but the Church maintain a presence everywhere through their preachers, bureaucrats, and the warrior nuns from the Weeping Matriarchy.

The Chelebs-Menau family shines like a mighty sun across the dockyards in the Icon City from their floating palace high above

the Intrapelagic Sea. In recent years, Chelebs have formed ties to the Zenithian Hegemony, and rumors whisper about a coming marriage between the builder masters and one of the purest and most exalted Hegemony families, which would create a blood bond across the whole Horizon.

The Weeping Matriarchy is an alliance of convents that are responsible for most of the Church's security on Mira and Antmira. The Triumvirate of Sisters, appointed for life, controls the Matriarchy.

Okra Darma is the closest thing to the Syndicate the Mirans have – a criminal network that lives off robberies and gullible or frightened pilgrims visiting the Icon City. Okra Darma's headquarters are hidden in the deep ravines on distant Menau, but their presence in the Icon City is anything but discreet.

OVERVIEW MIRA-A

Inos: Famous for the stone monuments of Gakour.

Mira: The home of the Church of the Icons.

Gherbis Station: The system hub for space traffic.

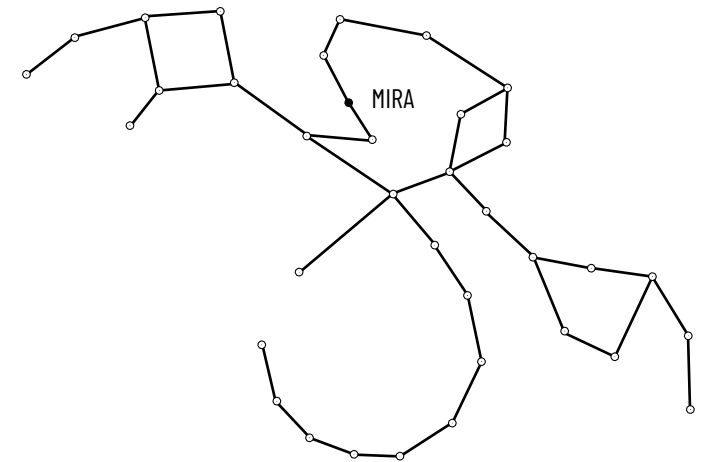
Zamih: Sand planet.

Khora: The prospectors' lap is located here.

Asteroid Belt: Home of rich monasteries and ascetic temples.

Jazaarar: Gas giant, mythical home of the Djinn.

Nahid: The home planet of the ascetic Rushana.



MIRA TODAY

The discovery of portal builder anti-grav technology during the Second Portal War led to advances in military and civilian vehicle design. The Chelebs family invested heavily in this new field. The results can be seen everywhere on Mira. The sky above the cities is filled with powerful grav runners, bikes and ferries. The traditional dhol, once sailing vessels that graced the ocean, now fly through the air to deliver cargo and passengers.

The Church of the Icon is by far the most influential faction on Mira, but the Chelebs family controls much of the rest of the system.

"Wherever you go on Mira, you can always bow to the Icons" is a common pilgrim saying, denoting the constant presence



TRIGON
4 AU

ANTMIRA
6 AU

ZHIR
10 AU

MAKOM
12 AU

OFAARED
25 AU

of religious architecture on the planet, from monuments and prophet's groves to prayer schools, monasteries, and Icon churches. The faith is a big part of everyday life, and all Mirans know the nine sacred rites from an early age:

The mission: Requires a believer to leave her home and travel the Horizon for one segment, spreading the faith.

The Life Bond: One should form a life bond with someone of the same or opposite gender. Divorce is forbidden.

The Creed: Once a year, during the Cyclade, a believer should openly declare her faith by reciting the creed in a temple.

The Blessing: Blessing one's home, ship, shop, or other business is done by all believers.

The Fast: During the segment of the Merchant, between dawn and dusk, the faithful must abstain from food and drink.

The Confession: The faithful should confess their sins once per segment, preferably to an anointed priest or priestess.

The Pilgrimage: There is one holy site that the faithful should visit at least once during their lives: the Icon City on Mira.

The Alms Giving: Giving alms to the poor pleases the Icons and should be done once per segment. A ninth of one's income is to be given away.

The Prayer: The faithful should pray twice a day, at dawn and dusk.

PILGRIMS

Mira and Menau are crisscrossed by pilgrim trails, paths, channels, and all manner of vehicles. Slowly the pilgrims travel across the holy lands. Neither pilgrims nor Mirans can see the point in rushing – the voyage is often a goal in itself.

THE ANTMIRA SYSTEM

There is a second star called Mira-B, or Antmira. While Antmira has planets suitable for human habitation, they are nowhere near as rich as the planet Mira. Trigon in Antmira is an industrialized world that seems to be of more interest to the Zenithian factions than to the Mirans themselves.

OVERVIEW ANTMIRA

Trigon: The Consortium has hold on this industrial planet.

Antmira: Dense metal planet.

Zhir: Known for Dukaam's garden domes.

Makom: Toxic gas giant.

Ofaared: Gas planet with giant skyfarms.

THE MENAU SYSTEM

The very remote Mira-C or Menau is suitable for colonization, too. But the enormous distances make it a less desirable place. Menau is home to scattered colonies and temples belonging to the Circle of Seekers.

OVERVIEW MENAU

Menau I: Pilgrim Destination with several sun temples.

Menau II: Rumoured to be the headquarters of the Okra Darma.

Menau III: The Temple of the Hyena-Headed Gambler.

Moshtari: Gas giant, famous for the "Jaws of Vasma" phenomenon.

Yahin: The planet of the blue rim storms.

Sufra: Pilgrimage of the Bling Ascet.

Comet Varnathar: Chelebs-Menau Exo Laboratory.

M I
2 AU

MENAU
3.5 AU

M III
5 AU

MOSHTARI
15 AU

YAHIN
25 AU

SUFRA
30 AU

COMET VARNATHAR
35-50 AU